



Frankie Fir

LODGE GARDENER

You know which flowers are pretty, and which are deadly.

FOR FRANKIE FIR'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

You look after Snowbury Lodge's grounds and greenhouse, and you carry your own greenhouse key.

COSTUME

Easy: Flannel shirt, wellies, garden gloves.
Go all out: country-estate gardener: a tweed flat cap or beanie, flannel, wellies and a potted poinsettia under one arm.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Morgan Ivy:** shares the greenhouse key hook with you
- **Robin Holly:** often pops into the greenhouse for greenery
- **Nick Frost:** owned the lodge; rarely noticed your work

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Protect your greenhouse's reputation
- Teach people which plants are dangerous
- Keep your own little side business to yourself

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You look after Snowbury Lodge's grounds and greenhouse, and you have your own greenhouse key.

YOUR SECRET

You've been quietly selling the lodge's prize poinsettias to the village florist.

You are innocent

You were in the village from 3:15 to 4:50, and you have a receipt.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Frankie



Your manner: Down to earth, practical and a bit gruff. Talk plants to anyone who'll listen, wipe imaginary soil off your hands and get prickly about the greenhouse.

LINES TO TRY

- "Foxglove's pretty, and it's deadly. Same as most things."
- "Deer can't get into my greenhouse. I checked."
- "I was in the village. I have the receipt."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Grumble: "I was in the village buying supplies. Ask the shop."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Explain that the greenhouse grows foxglove, which is lovely and very poisonous, and that only someone who knows plants would think of it.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You were in the village from 3:15 to 4:50 buying supplies.
- Gossip: several people borrow the hall key for greenery at Christmas.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Sam how a novelist knows so much about poisonous plants.
- Ask Casey whether anything went missing from the kitchen today.

MINI TASK

Teach two guests the difference: holly has spiky leaves and red berries; foxglove has tall stalks of bell-shaped flowers.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Confirm your log: all fine at 3:00, three foxglove stalks freshly cut at 5:00. You told Morgan.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- The cut ends were still wet at 5:00, so they had been cut not long before.
- If Morgan mentions poinsettias going missing, change the subject.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan what they did after you reported the foxglove.
- Ask who signed out the hall key this afternoon.

MINI TASK

With one other player, use the key log to work out who could reach the greenhouse between 3:00 and 5:00.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Alex Snow | ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Add a detail: there was sawdust in the soil by the foxglove bed, and your greenhouse never has sawdust in it.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Sawdust doesn't blow in from outside. Someone carried it in on their clothes.
- Deer cannot get into your greenhouse. You checked the door.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask who in the lodge works with sawdust every day.
- Ask Jordan what they smelled outside the study at 3:30.

MINI TASK

Before ballots, give a 30-second "expert witness" statement about the foxglove to the room.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim